

## Developing Sources-10/22/2024

- **Invest in yourself**
  - As general assignment reporter, stopped by PD's every day **before** shift
    - Shows you're interested
    - They now recognize you. Be seen and look for common interests
      - In my case-kids/sports/gardening
      - PIO's become detectives, chiefs, town managers, mayors
- **Get your name out there**
  - Public appearances
    - Look at them as an opportunity to make more contacts...bring cards!
  - Social media-post every day. Be on multiple platforms
  - Give out your business cards LIKE CANDY (physical and virtual cards)
    - Have cards in your wallet, purse, every single jacket
    - Tack on bulletin boards in Starbucks, town squares, auto shop, diner
- **Source Yield**-something you need to think about if you're always in a time crunch
- **Holiday Cards!**-it works
- **Sources CAN be friends** (you have no choice...sorta...be careful)
  - Happens all the time
  - Awkward situations
    - Make it clear you will report things that may impact his/her organization, good or bad
    - "just don't screw up"
    - Don't take every tip they give. They don't expect you to, or shouldn't. Watch for slant just like you would anyone
    - May have to avoid topics you don't agree on
  - PRO TIP on boundaries...heard this a while back...I do this now
    - Wear your badge prominently
    - Don't take calls off hours/certain days/times of week